

Sick and Wellness Leave Policy

Policy ID	HR-LEAVE-102	Owner	People Operations
Effective	January 1, 2026	Next review	January 1, 2027
Status	Current	Classification	Internal
Audience	Employees, managers, and payroll partners	Company	Northstar Technologies (fictional)

Document notice: This policy is fictional and was created for retrieval-augmented generation testing. It is not legal, tax, medical, or employment advice.

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy governs short-term illness, medical appointments, wellness leave, reporting expectations, documentation, and pay treatment. It does not replace longer protected leave described in the Family, Medical, and Parental Leave Policy.

This policy applies across company offices and approved remote locations unless a local addendum or controlling law provides a different rule. Employees should use the current policy version and ask the listed owner when facts do not fit the standard case.

2. Summary of Key Rules

Leave type	Full-time allowance	Carry forward	Evidence
Sick leave	10 days per calendar year	No	May apply after 3 consecutive days
Wellness day	2 days from sick allowance	No	No medical evidence
Medical appointment	Uses sick leave	No	Appointment confirmation if requested

3. Notification and Recording

Employees should notify their manager as soon as reasonably possible and normally before the start of the scheduled work period. The absence must be recorded in the HR portal when the employee is able to do so. A manager may record the absence on the employee's behalf. Employees should not include diagnoses or detailed medical information in routine absence notes.

4. Documentation and Privacy

For more than three consecutive scheduled workdays, People Operations may request a fitness-for-work note or other reasonable confirmation. Earlier documentation may be requested when required by law, for a workplace accommodation, or when a documented pattern of absence is under review. Medical records are handled as restricted information and are not stored in general personnel notes.

5. Pay, Balance, and Carry Forward

Eligible sick leave is paid at the employee's regular base rate and does not include overtime, bonuses, or expense allowances. Unused sick leave does not carry forward and is not paid out at separation. Employees who exhaust the allowance should contact People Operations to discuss annual leave, unpaid leave, an accommodation, or a protected leave program.

6. Return to Work

Managers may conduct a brief return-to-work conversation focused on readiness, workload, and support. Employees must not return when doing so would conflict with public health guidance or a medical restriction. A temporary workplace adjustment may be arranged under the accommodation process and should not be treated as remote-work approval.

7. Exceptions, Records, and Questions

Exceptions must be lawful, documented, limited in duration, and approved by the policy owner plus any other owner named in the relevant section. Approval for one case does not change the policy for other employees. Records are retained according to the company retention schedule and any legal hold.

Related documents: Annual Leave and Company Holidays Policy; Family, Medical, and Parental Leave Policy; Remote and Hybrid Work Policy.

Version history

Version	Effective date	Change
1.0	January 1, 2026	Initial fictional policy issued for RAG evaluation.